

HOW MUCH DO YOU KNOW ABOUT BRITISH INVENTIONS?



MRI SCANNER

Sir Peter Mansfield (1933–2017), a British scientist, is the co-inventor of the magnetic resonance imaging (MRI) scanner. This enables doctors and researchers to obtain exact and non-invasive images of human internal organs and has revolutionised diagnostic medicine.



TELEVISION

Developed by Scotsman John Logie Baird (1888–1946) in the 1920s. In 1932 he made the first television broadcast between London and Glasgow



DNA

The structure of the DNA molecule: This discovery contributed to many scientific advances, particularly in medicine and fighting crime. Francis Crick (1916–2004), one of those awarded the Nobel Prize for this discovery, was British.



ATM

The cash-dispensing ATM: In the 1960s, James Goodfellow (1937–) invented the cash-dispensing ATM (automatic teller machine) or 'cashpoint'.



HARRIER

The Harrier jump jet, an aircraft capable of taking off vertically, was also designed and developed in the UK.



IVF

IVF (in-vitro fertilisation) therapy: Designed to treat infertility, IVF was pioneered in Britain by physiologist Sir Robert Edwards (1925–2013) and gynaecologist Patrick Steptoe (1913–88). The world's first 'test-tube baby' was born in Oldham, Lancashire in 1978.



WORLD WIDE WEB

The World Wide Web was invented by British computer scientist Sir Tim Berners-Lee (1955–). Information was successfully transferred via the web for the first time on 25 December 1990.



MAMMAL CLONE

In 1996, two British scientists, Sir Ian Wilmut (1944–) and Keith Campbell (1954–2012), led a team which was the first to succeed in cloning a mammal, Dolly the sheep. This has led to further research into the possible use of cloning to preserve endangered species and for medical purposes.

